

Daily Market Summary

August 21, 2026

Market Tone — Today's Session

A recap of how the market traded today — not a forecast.

Today: **+0.24 → Slightly Bullish**

Trend (5-day EMA): **+0.01 → Neutral** — smoothed, the readable day-over-day signal.

Component	Weight	Score
Market data	70%	+0.26
News headlines	20%	+0.30
Fed (rate expectations)	10%	-0.05

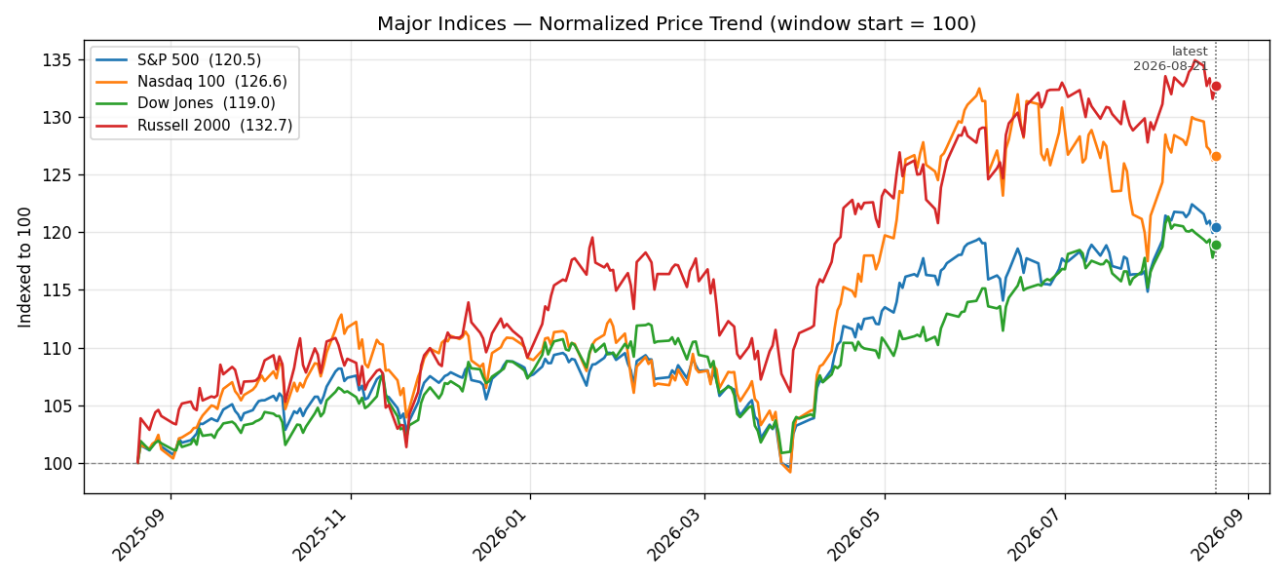
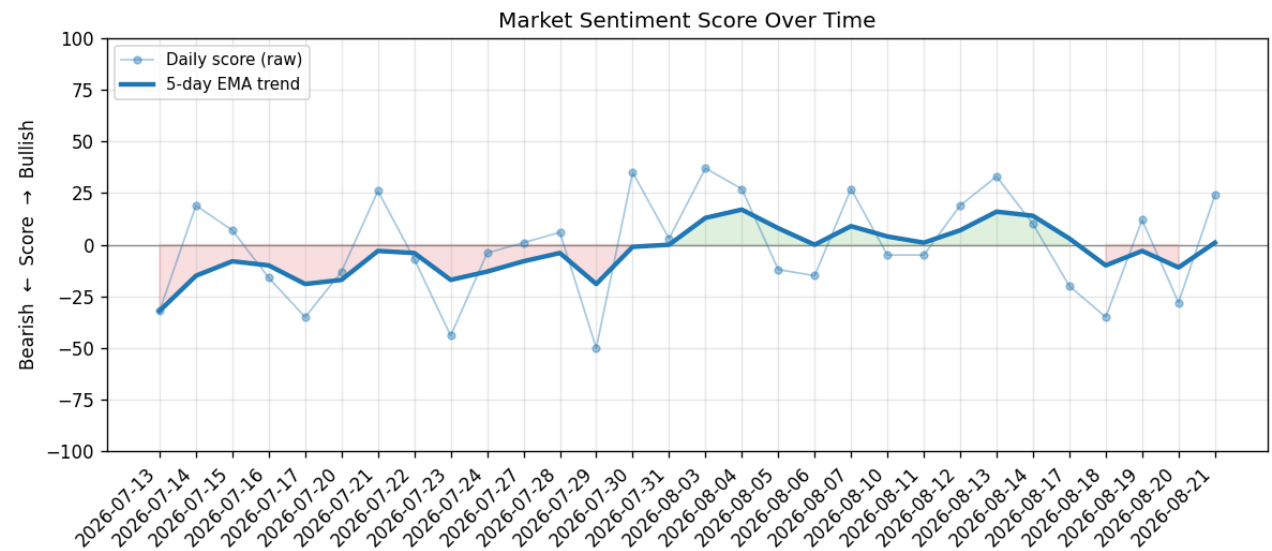
Equities rose with Nasdaq +0.3%, S&P 500 +0.4%, VIX -5.5%. Sector breadth: 8/11 sectors up. 10Y yield +0.9%. News headlines read bullish. Fed-policy expectations tightened (13-Week T-Bill Yield +0.7bp). Today's overall market tone: Slightly Bullish. (news scored with finbert)

Standout headlines

Most bullish (+0.92) — Mortgage and refinance interest rates today, Friday, August 21, 2026: Rates stand on high ground despite bond market buybacks

Most bearish (-0.01) — Former JPMorgan exec takes on Social Security advisory role

Trend Charts



Sector Watch (AI Stack)

Score describes the day: driven by the session move (70%), with breadth (avg % of the 20/50-day MAs the basket trades above, 15%) and news (15%) for texture. Relative strength (vs the Nasdaq for tech baskets, the S&P for the rest) is shown as a context column but doesn't drive the label. Sorted strongest→weakest.

Sector	Move	Rel. Str.	Breadth	News	Overall
SaaS	+1.82%	+1.49% vs Nasdaq	83%	Slightly Bullish	Bullish (+0.74)
Pharma / Healthcare	+1.25%	+0.82% vs S&P	88%	Slightly Bullish	Bullish (+0.64)
Consumer	+1.03%	+0.60% vs S&P	31%	Slightly Bearish	Bullish (+0.37)
Networking / Interconnect	+0.84%	+0.51% vs Nasdaq	43%	Neutral	Bullish (+0.36)
Semiconductors / Compute	+0.36%	+0.03% vs Nasdaq	50%	Neutral	Slightly Bullish (+0.25)
Hyperscalers & Neoclouds	+0.43%	+0.10% vs Nasdaq	50%	Slightly Bearish	Slightly Bullish (+0.23)
Banking	+0.53%	+0.10% vs S&P	25%	Neutral	Slightly Bullish (+0.19)
Memory (DRAM/NAND/HBM)	-0.53%	-0.86% vs Nasdaq	38%	Neutral	Bearish (-0.33)

Positioning & Regime

Was today bullish or bearish, read through positioning: out-of-the-money put/call volume (hedging vs chasing, daily) and short %-of-float (squeeze fuel; exchange data, biweekly) explain the character of the day's move — squeeze rebound, hedged advance, conviction selling. **Under evaluation** — logged daily, drives no scores.

Basket	OTM P/C	Short Fit	Day	Today's Read
SaaS	1.14	4.0%	+1.82%	Bullish — advance, but heavily hedged — protection still bid
Pharma / Healthcare	1.03	1.7%	+1.24%	Bullish — broad advance; positioning unremarkable
Consumer	0.81	2.1%	+1.02%	Bullish — broad advance; positioning unremarkable
Memory (DRAM/NAND/HBM)	0.73	5.7%	-0.53%	Bearish — orderly decline; positioning unremarkable
Banking	0.70	0.0%	+0.53%	Bullish — broad advance; positioning unremarkable
Hyperscalers & Neoclouds	0.46	1.4%	+0.43%	Bullish — broad advance; positioning unremarkable
Networking / Interconnect	0.46	4.1%	+0.84%	Bullish — broad advance; positioning unremarkable

Semiconductors / Compute	0.36	2.4%	+0.36%	Bullish — broad advance; positioning unremarkable
All tracked	0.54	2.5%	+0.83%	Bullish — broad advance; positioning unremarkable

Top Gainers

Company	Price	% Change
SELLAS Life Sciences Group, Inc (SLS)	15.46	+15.37%
IQM Quantum Computers Oyj (IQMX)	11.11	+14.77%
Robinhood Markets, Inc. (HOOD)	108.13	+13.70%
USA Rare Earth, Inc. (USAR)	19.26	+12.57%
Inflection, Inc. (INFQ)	14.12	+12.51%

Top News

- Mortgage and refinance interest rates today, Friday, August 21, 2026: Rates stand on high ground despite bond market buybacks** — Yahoo Finance
- Tesla’s stock jumps as the company gets cleared for a Las Vegas robotaxi launch** — MarketWatch (Top)

The automaker plans to soon launch its Cybercab in Austin, Texas, and got the nod to deploy thousands of vehicles in Nevada.
- Kalshi traders think the bitcoin rally could end the year near current levels** — CNBC (Finance)

Speculators on the prediction market platform think it's most likely that the cryptocurrency will end 2026 close to where it's now trading.
- Here’s how Bessent’s newly activist Treasury Department is undercutting the Fed’s Warsh** — MarketWatch (Top)

The surprising move this week by Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent to intervene in Treasury markets to lower the cost of government debt undercuts the credibility of Federal Reserve Chairman Kevin Warsh to make interest-rate policy, experts said.
- Trump admin taps former JPMorgan Chase exec Matt Zames to advise Social Security agency** — CNBC (Finance)

Matt Zames is taking an unpaid position to help his former JPMorgan colleague Frank Bisignano tackle modernization of the SSA, CNBC has learned.

Market Snapshot

Major Indices

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
S&P 500	7,674.37	+33.21	+0.43%
Nasdaq 100	29,308.86	+95.70	+0.33%
Dow Jones	53,277.01	+517.80	+0.98%
Russell 2000	3,017.87	+25.44	+0.85%
VIX	15.13	-0.88	-5.50%

Key Stocks

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
Nvidia	214.72	-2.13	-0.98%
Microsoft	483.24	+2.09	+0.43%
AMD	473.25	+3.79	+0.81%
Meta	549.90	+4.07	+0.75%
Alphabet	341.75	+3.55	+1.05%
Broadcom	368.45	+4.42	+1.21%
Micron	966.78	-7.55	-0.77%
Intel	90.07	-2.06	-2.24%
SanDisk	1,596.08	-4.54	-0.28%
Coherent	289.52	-0.51	-0.18%
Amazon	258.63	-1.48	-0.57%
Apple	309.35	-1.95	-0.63%
Arm	243.32	-7.40	-2.95%

Commodities & Crypto

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
Gold	4,661.60	+90.20	+1.97%
Crude Oil	86.64	-0.19	-0.22%
Bitcoin	78,308.99	+5,298.13	+7.26%

FX Rates

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
EUR/USD	1.17	-0.00	-0.02%
USD/JPY	158.94	-0.09	-0.06%
GBP/USD	1.36	+0.00	+0.13%

Interest Rates

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
10Y Treasury Yield	4.74	+0.04	+0.89%
13-Week T-Bill Yield	3.71	+0.01	+0.19%